

CANYU GAO

School of Public Affairs and Administration, Rutgers University-Newark

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EDUCATION

Ph.D. in Public Administration

Expected May 2027

Rutgers University-Newark, Newark, NJ, U.S.

Dissertation: *The Contingent Effects of Artificial Intelligence on Public Management: Evidence Across Bureaucrats, Public Organizations, and Citizens*

Committee: Kaifeng Yang (Chair), Norma Riccucci, Gregory Porumbescu, Sanjay Pandey

Master of Public Administration

2022

Renmin University of China, Beijing, China.

B.A. in Public Administration

2020

South China University of Technology, Guangzhou, China.

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Digital Governance, Artificial Intelligence, Organizational Theory and Behavior, Accountability, Social Equity, Citizen-Government Relations, State and Local Governance

PEER-REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS

Gao, C., & Riccucci, N. M. (2026). AI in Policing and Perceived Legitimacy: Does Gender Representation Make a Difference? *Public Administration Review*. Advance online publication. <https://doi.org/10.1111/puar.70214>

Gao, C., & Yang, K. (2026). Identity Threat and Affective Commitment after Reorganization: The Moderating Role of Public Service Motivation among Chinese Firefighters. *International Public Management Journal*. Forthcoming.

Gao, C., Caldarulo, M., & Porumbescu, G. (2026). Linking Broadband Availability to Perceived Digital Skills: The Moderating Role of Education. *State and Local Government Review*. Advance online publication. <https://doi.org/10.1177/0160323X261455619>

Yang, K., Gao, C., & Liu, Y. (2025). Behavioral Ethics: Does it Have a Role in Helping Develop a Better Understanding of Administrative Ethics? *The American Review of Public Administration*, 55(4), 283-298. <https://doi.org/10.1177/02750740241305413>

MANUSCRIPTS UNDER REVIEW

Canyu Gao, “AI-Informed Public Officials’ Misconduct and Citizens’ Racialized Blame Attribution” (Under Review at *Public Performance & Management Review*)

Canyu Gao and Ricardo Bello-Gomez, “How Does AI in Public Decision-Making Shape Performance Evaluation and Responsibility Attribution?” (Under Review at *Public Management Review*)

Canyu Gao, José Acevedo, and Ricardo Bello-Gomez, “Deservingness in Administrative Errors and Racialized Perceived Legitimacy: Evidence from a Survey Experiment” (Under Review at *Administration & Society*)

WORK IN PROGRESS

Canyu Gao, “The Performance Effect of Government AI Adoption Across Racial Contexts: Does Centralization Help?” (Draft complete. Target: *Journal of Public Administration Research and Theory*)

Canyu Gao and Kaifeng Yang, “The Contingent Relationship Between Artificial Intelligence Adoption and Public Employees’ Job Satisfaction: The Case of the U.S. Federal Government” (Draft complete. Target: *Review of Public Personnel Administration*)

Canyu Gao, Yifan Guo, and Kaifeng Yang, “Making Responsible AI Plans: An Accountability Framework and the State of Practice” (Draft nearing completion. Target: *Public Administration Review*)

Diego Galego, **Canyu Gao**, and Chris Walker, “‘New’ Policy Instruments in the Digital Government Era? Insights from a Scoping Literature Review and OECD Country Reports” (Draft nearing completion. Target: *Government Information Quarterly*)

RESEARCH REPORTS & PUBLIC WRITING

Gao, C. (2026). *Slowing Down Artificial Intelligence in Policing*. New Jersey State Policy Lab. <https://policylab.rutgers.edu/publication/slowing-down-artificial-intelligence-in-policing/>

Porumbescu, G., **Gao, C.**, & Caldarulo, M. (2024). *Linking Broadband Availability and Education to Digital Skills*. New Jersey State Policy Lab. <https://policylab.rutgers.edu/publication/report-release-linking-broadband-availability-and-education-to-digital-skills/>

Gao, C. (2023). *Digital Technologies Might Not Necessarily Reduce Cognitive Bias and Inequality*. New Jersey State Policy Lab. <https://policylab.rutgers.edu/publication/digital-technologies-might-not-necessarily-reduce-cognitive-bias-and-inequality/>

GRANTS, FELLOWSHIPS, AND AWARDS

Co-PI with PI Kaifeng Yang, Seed Grant (\$3,750), New Jersey State Policy Lab “AI in Policing and Perceived Legitimacy: The Role of Human Resource Practices”	2026
Dissertation Fellowship (\$30,833), Rutgers University	2026
American Society for Public Administration (ASPA) Founders’ Fellowship Award	2026
Dissertation Fellowship (\$1,000), China-America Association for Public Affairs	2026
Research Grant (\$800), Rutgers School of Public Affairs and Administration	2025
Graduate Student Travel Awards, Rutgers University-Newark	2024, 2025

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Instructor of Record

Understanding Public Administration and the Public Sector (Online, Undergraduate)	[4.85/5], Rutgers University, Spring 2026
Understanding Public Administration and the Public Sector (In-person, Undergraduate)	[4.14/5], Rutgers University, Fall 2025

Teaching Assistant

Data Analysis (Online, Graduate)	Rutgers University, Spring 2025
Study of Public Organizations (In-person, Graduate)	Rutgers University, Spring 2025
Principles of Public Administration (Online, Graduate)	Rutgers University, Spring 2024

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

- 2026** “AI and Job Satisfaction—Temporal Dynamics, Heterogeneous Effect, and Boundary Conditions.” *Public Management Research Conference (PMRC)*, Washington, D.C.
- “When Bureaucracies Err: Loss Aversion, Deservingness, and Citizen Perceptions.” *Public Management Research Conference (PMRC)*, Washington, D.C.
- “AI in Policing and Perceived Legitimacy: Does Gender Representation Make a Difference?” *Midwest Political Science Association Conference (MPSA)*, Chicago, IL.
- “When Governments Choose AI: Implications for Responsibility and Performance Assessment.” *Midwest Political Science Association Conference (MPSA)*, Chicago, IL.
- “Racialized Accountability Judgments in Policing: How Does AI Make a Difference?” *American Society for Public Administration Conference (ASPA)*, Los Angeles, CA.
- 2025** “Linking Broadband Availability to Perceived Digital Skills: The Moderating Role of Education.” *Northeast Conference on Public Administration (NECoPA)*, Union, NJ.

“Algorithmic Effectiveness and Transparency: Understanding Public Employees’ Responses to Automated Decision-Making in the Public Sector.” *Public Management Research Conference* (PMRC), Seoul, South Korea.

2024 “Making Responsible AI Plans: An Accountability Framework and the State of Practice.” *American Society for Public Administration Conference* (ASPA), Minneapolis, MN.

PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

Journal Reviewer

Journal of Public Administration Research and Theory
Review of Policy Research
Journal of Public Policy
Local Government Studies
Social Policy & Administration

Policy Brief Editorial Assistant

2026

School of Public Affairs and Administration, Rutgers University-Newark

Graduate Student Advisory Board Member

2025-2026

The China-America Association for Public Affairs

Conference Volunteer

Northeast Conference on Public Administration

2025

PROFESSIONAL AFFILIATIONS

American Society for Public Administration (ASPA)
Public Management Research Association (PMRA)
Midwest Political Science Association (MPSA)

SKILLS

Methods: Panel Data Econometrics, Regression Discontinuity (RD), Instrumental Variables (IV), Difference-in-Differences (DiD), Computational Text Analysis
Statistical Packages: Stata, R, Python, SPSS
Languages: English (fluent), Mandarin (native)

Last updated: September 2026